

Clue-less

Setting: The Peace Haven Bungalow, Perry Cross Road, Bandra, Mumbai. The Bungalow has a Kitchen, a Dining room, a Library, a Hall, a Lounge and a Study.

Main Props: Candlestick, Rope, Lead pipe, Knife, Gun, Wrench, Walls, Blackmail folder.

Characters:-

- 1) Sebastian Butler: Tristan- Prim, Snooty and Dramatically over-qualified. The Butler
- 2) Mr. Gregory **Green**: Hriday - Happy go lucky. Wealthy Bandra socialite.
- 3) Colonel Melvin Mustard: Kiaan- Pompous, Loud, Proud. A retired army officer dismissed from service for drinking on duty.
- 4) Professor Patrick Plum: Aahan- Absent Minded, Distracted. Retired Professor who dated a student.
- 5) Mr. Victor Boddy: _____ - Ruthless and Dominating. The Blackmailer and Victim. A property developer.
- 6) Mrs. Patricia **Peacock**: Avni- Judgemental, terrified, over the top. Buys votes for her Husband (a Minister)
- 7) Mrs. Selena **Scarlet**: _____ - Glamorous, Flirtatious. Has been running an unlicensed wellness products business.
- 8) Mrs. Wilma **White**: Kiah- Widowed, murderously calm, mysterious. Murdered her husband/claims to be a widow for pension.
- 9) The Maid **Rosie**: _____ - Clumsy
- 10) **The Cook**: _____ - Fed up with everything.

CUES

Aside = [a]

Pause = [p]

Overlap (cutting someone off while the other keeps speaking, then slowly stops) = [o]

Whisper = [w]

Stutter = [s]

Mutter = [m]

Emphasis = [e]

SCENE 1 (HALL)

(lights hitting the stage come on)

AUDIO 1: Thunder and Rain

All this to be placed Before Curtains Open

Walls- Towards stage RIGHT perpendicular to the audience.

Coat Rack- Nearly centre stage, extreme back

Table with glasses and a bottle

(Sebastian stands centre stage, consulting a notepad.)

SEBASTIAN:

Seven o'clock. On the dot. Which means, given Bandra Standard Time, they will arrive between eight and nine-thirty, each one blaming the traffic and the roads.

SEBASTIAN:

[a] Oh, Good evening. My name is Sebastian Butler. Yes, Butler is my surname and yes, I am a butler. Tonight, six very unimportant guests are arriving at this bungalow for a dinner party. They do not know each other. They do not know why they were invited. And they absolutely do not know that their host...

...is a blackmailer.

Rosie! Is dinner ready yet?

(ROSIE enters from the stage LEFT carrying a tray of glasses. She immediately trips, catches herself and loses one glass. She quietly kicks the glass offstage and straightens up as if nothing happened.)

ROSIE:

Mrs. Cook! Is dinner ready yet?

(THE COOK enters from the stage LEFT with a knife in hand)

THE COOK:

Dinner will be ready at 7:30. I suggest lowering your expectations and avoiding the soup.

AUDIO 2: Doorbell

(Sebastian shoos Rosie and the Cook offstage)

COL MUSTARD:

Arey baba, what to tell you men. One fellow stopped in the middle of Turner signal to argue with a rickshaw. Whole of Bandra has become one big parking lot.

SEBASTIAN:

Please come on in sir, you are expected.

(Sebastian takes the Colonel's coat and hangs it)

AUDIO 3: Doorbell

(Rosie offers the Colonel a drink.)

SEBASTIAN:

Good evening, Miss Scarlet. Your host is expecting you.

SCARLET:

Of course he is, darling. Everyone expects me. I'm known by all, loved by most and hated by none. I do apologise for being late but I refuse to rush for anybody. I'm a Sandra from Bandra after all.

COL MUSTARD:

Colonel Melvin Mustard. Retired army officer, full-time Goan.

AUDIO 4: Doorbell

WHITE:

Pardon my late arrival. There was traffic near Mount Mary's, then a wedding outside St. Andrew's, and a funeral at St. Peter's.

AUDIO 5: Doorbell

(Enter Peacock)

PEACOCK:

Hello, dears! Patricia Peacock- but honestly nobody calls me that. It's Auntie Patty jaar. Everybody at church knows me. I'm President of the Church Committee, vice-president of the choir committee and unofficial chairman of everybody else's business.

(Enter Prof Plum)

PROF PLUM:

Sorry I'm late! Parking in Bandra is harder than getting into heaven men. I've got puffs from Hearsch, chicken lollipops from Candies, ribbon sandwiches from Andora's, and enough mawa cake from Merwans to survive a power cut.

SEBASTIAN:

Remarkable. Most guests bring a bottle of wine. You appear to have brought Bandra.

AUDIO 6: Doorbell

GREEN:

[s] Terrible terrible weather! It's like Peter and Paul are playing bat and ball up in the clouds. Good evening, everyone! I don't think we've met. Gregory Green at your service.

SEBASTIAN:

Incorrect. Sebastian Butler at your service.

COL MUSTARD:

Your surname's Butler? What sort of name is Butler for a Bandra Catholic?

SEBASTIAN:

The sort the host insists upon, sir.

COL MUSTARD:

What exactly do you do?

SEBASTIAN:

I buttle.

COL MUSTARD:

Which means what?

SEBASTIAN:

The butler is head of the kitchen and dining room. About the dining room, may I escort you all there for dinner?

SCENE 2 (DINING ROOM)

GREEN:

Speaking about a party, Sebastian, where are the balloons? Or the cake or piñata?

SEBASTIAN:

A curious expectation, Mr. Green. Were you under the impression we'd hired a clown as well?

ROSIE:

Other than Professor Plum's considerate catering, we have Sorpotal, Vindaloo, Pickle and my Grandma Nancy's famous Fugias.

COL MUSTARD:

What men bugger! I'm trying to lose weight and you're tempting me like the devil during Lent.

PEACOCK:

Arrey, you know that Natasha down the road na, that Maggie's niece. She's looking for a husband. Professor, you would suit her very well.

PROF PLUM:

You Bandra aunties work faster than dating apps.

SCARLET:

Nowadays these kids are getting into, what's that called, situation-situationships.

PEACOCK:

Situation-ship? There is a situation on the ship? Aai saiba my son is on the ship!

GREEN:

Nono, you'll senior citizens don't understand anything only. Forget it, forget it. Why don't we get to know each other? Mrs. Peacock, where is it that you work?

PEACOCK:

Well you don't need to work when you're the wife of a-- [*o*] Oh but then I forgot, the letter said we're not supposed to say who we really are.

SCARLET:

(ominously) [*m*] I know who you are. I live in Bandra too.

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey, Bandruh? So you're a politician's wife?

PEACOCK:

Yes, yes I am. So, what does your husband do? I must know somebody who knows him.

WHITE:

[*e*] NOTHING! Well, he just lies around on his back all day.

SCARLET:

Sounds like hard work to me.

PROF PLUM:

So what do you do in Bandra Miss Scarlet?

SCARLET:

I run a successful beauty business. If you've ever seen an auntie at a wedding looking ten years younger than she is, that's my work. It's amazing what people will pay to avoid mirrors.

WHITE:

And you? You're a professor right?

PROF PLUM:

I was, but I've retired.

SCARLET:

Those who can't do, teach.

PLUM:

And those who can't teach?

SCARLET:

Open a beauty business. Obviously!

GREEN:

Well, I'm into fundraisers.

WHITE:

You organise them?

GREEN:

I attend them. Mainly for the food and to dress fancy. But mainly for the food.

PROF PLUM:

Are you a real Colonel?

COL MUSTARD:

I am, sir.

SCARLET:

You're not going to mention the coincidence that you also live in Bandra? Don't you?

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey how you know, men? Who told you? Have we met before?

SCARLET:

I've certainly seen you before, although you may not have seen Me.

PEACOCK:

Well, does anyone here not live in Bandra?

PROF PLUM:

(Gets up from table and walks to Sebastian) Sebastian, where is our host and why have we been brought here?

AUDIO 7: Doorbell

(Conversation happens offstage RIGHT)

SEBASTIAN:

Ah, good evening. You are eagerly awaited.

AUDIO 8: Door getting locked

BODDY:

Are you locking me in? I'll take the key.

SEBASTIAN:

Over my [*e*] DEAD body, sir. May I take your bag?

BODDY:

No, I'll leave it here. I need it.

SEBASTIAN:

It contains evidence I presume?

BODDY:

Surprises, my friend. It contains surprises.

SEBASTIAN:

Ladies and Gentlemen, may I present the seventh guest Mr. Boddy?

BODDY:

What are they doing here?

SEBASTIAN:

Eating dinner. Do sit down Mr. Boddy.

WHITE:

Look, I demand to know what's going on here. Why have we all been dragged here to this horrible place?

SEBASTIAN:

Well, I believe we all received a letter. My letter says, “It will be to your advantage to be present on this date because a SOME-Boddy will bring to end a certain long-standing confidential and painful financial liability. It is signed, a friend.”

BIG 6:

(unanimously) So did I.

BODDY:

I also received a similar letter.

SEBASTIAN:

Forgive my curiosity Mr. Boddy, but did your letter say the same thing?

BODDY:

No.

SEBASTIAN:

I see. May I suggest we adjourn to the study for coffee and brandy, at which point I believe our unknown host will reveal his intentions.

SCENE 3 (STUDY)

SEBASTIAN:

Ladies and Gentlemen, I’m instructed to explain to you what you all have in common with each other. Unless you would care to do the honours Mr. Boddy?

BODDY:

Why me? They know who I am?

SEBASTIAN:

I don’t think so. You’ve never identified yourself to them. Ladies and Gents, you all have one thing in common. You’re ALL being blackmailed. For some considerable time, all of you have been paying what you can afford, and in some cases, MORE than you can afford to someone who threatens to expose you. And none of you know who’s blackmailing you.

PEACOCK:

Aavouis! Blackmailing us all it seems! I’ve never heard anything so ridiculous. If I’d done anything improper, the church WhatsApp group would’ve known before I did! Paying more than we can afford to keep someone quiet it seems.

SEBASTIAN:

Anybody else wish to deny it? Very well, Professor Plum, you were once an esteemed Professor of Biology. But your license to teach has been lifted. Correct?

SCARLET:

Why, what did he do?

SEBSATIAN:

You know how Professors aren't allowed to date their students?

SCARLET:

Yeah?

SEBASTIAN:

Well he did.

PEACOCK:

Shehh! Don't you have any shame?

SEBASTIAN:

Are YOU making moral judgements Mrs. Peacock? How then do you justify taking bribes in return for delivering your husband, Minister Peacock's vote?

PEACOCK:

It's a vicious lie! Utter rubbish! *(Gets up and walks to a corner)*

WHITE:

I too am being blackmailed for something I didn't do.

GREEN:

Me too.

COL MUSTARD:

Aavouis, morre, me too!

SCARLET:

Not me

SEBASTIAN:

You're NOT being blackmailed?

SCARLET:

Oh, I'm being blackmailed all right. But I did what I'm being blackmailed for.

GREEN:

What did you do?

SCARLET:

I've been running an unlicensed beauty business out of my flat, essentially charging desperate aunties enormous sums for fake skincare treatments and dubious herbal cures.

WHITE:

So how did you know Colonel Mustard lives in Bandra? Was he one of your clients?

COL MUSTARD:

Arey baba, absolutely not! Maka Naka!

WHITE:

I was asking Miss Scarlet.

COL MUSTARD:

You tell him it's not true!

SCARLET:

It's not true.

COL MUSTARD:

Is that true?

SCARLET:

No, it's not true.

GREEN:

Hah, so it is true.

SEBASTIAN:

A double negative!

COL MUSTARD:

You mean you have photographs?

SEBASTIAN:

That sounds like a confession to me. In fact, the double negative has proved to be positive.

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey duffer! Are you trying to make me look stupid in front of the other guests?

SEBASTIAN:

You don't need any help from me, sir.

COL MUSTARD:

That's right! *(Says it confidently, then realises and looks confused.)*

SEBASTIAN:

It was also rather 'smart' of you to be drinking, let's say, a rather large bottle of Feni on duty.

COL MUSTARD:

It was just a quarter....and 5 more quarters resulting in a litre.

SEBASTIAN:

Mrs. White, you've been paying our friend the blackmailer ever since your husband died under, shall we say, mysterious circumstances.

SCARLET:

OH! HAA!

WHITE:

Why is that funny?

SCARLET:

I see. That's why he was lying around on his back. In his coffin.

WHITE:

Well, I didn't kill him.

PLUM:

Then why are you paying the blackmailer?

WHITE:

I don't want a scandal now do I? He was a lunatic. He didn't seem to like me very much. He had threatened to kill me in public.

GREEN:

And why would he want to kill you in public?

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey, I think she meant, he threatened in public to kill her.

SCARLET:

Was that his final word on the matter?

WHITE:

Being killed is pretty final, wouldn't you say?

SEBASTIAN:

And yet he was the one who died, not you Mrs. White, NOT YOU!

PEACOCK:

Do you miss him?

WHITE:

Well, it's a matter of life after death. Now that he's dead, I have a life.

GREEN:

I have something to say, I'm not going to wait for Sebastian to unmask me. I attend fundraisers for charitable causes. Since the beginning of the year, I have attended 47.....And donated a grand total of 200 rupees. I am also a homosexual. I feel no personal shame or guilt about this, but I must keep it a secret to keep getting invited to fundraisers. And if the Bandra aunties find out, they'll stop trying to introduce me to Maggie's neice.....Thank you.

(Sits back on the sofa with Prof Plum. Prof Plum immediately gets ups)

PROF PLUM:

Well, that only leaves Mr. Boddy. What's your secret?

SEBASTIAN:

His secret? Oh, hadn't you guessed, he's the one who's been blackmailing you all.

AUDIO 9: Loud Thunder

(All start arguing)

SEBASTIAN:

[s] Wait! Wait! The COPS are coming! Blackmail depends on secrecy. You've all admitted how he's been able to blackmail you. All you have to do is tell the police, he'll be caught and your troubles will be over! I have evidence and Rosie is tape recording this entire conversation as we speak.

(Mr Boddy pushes past everyone, goes offstage and gets his briefcase. He takes out the weapons and hands them to everyone)

AUDIO 10: Ominous music

SCARLET:

A candlestick? What's this for?

WHITE:

Rope?

GREEN:

A lead pipe?

COL MUSTARD:

A wrench?

PROF PLUM:

Why would you give me a revolver?

PEACOCK:

I don't want a knife!

COL MUSTARD:

Everybody relax re, nobody's died.

BODDY:

In your hands, you each possess a lethal weapon. If you get me arrested, you will also be exposed and humiliated. But, if one of you kills Sebastian now, no one but the 7 of us would know. He has the key to the front door, which he said would only be opened over his dead body. The only way to avoid finding yourself in the Times is for one of you to kill him. Now. (claps twice)

blackout

(thuds heard)

AUDIO 11: Gunshot

(Peacock screams)

(lights come on slowly)

(Mr Boddy dead on the ground)

GREEN:

Arey Deva!

COL MUSTARD:

Aai saiba bogos, men. I spoke too soon.

PEACOCK:

Is he alive?

PROF PLUM:

STAND BACK! Let me see. *[e]* HE'S DEAD.

PEACOCK:

Who had the gun?

PROF PLUM:

I did.

PEACOCK:

Then you shot him!

PROF PLUM:

I didn't! Somebody tried to grab the gun from me in the dark and the gun went off. But look, he doesn't have a bullet hole.

GREEN:

Then who killed him?

PROF PLUM:

I DON'T KNOW!!

PEACOCK:

Oh, I need a drink.

WHITE:

Maybe he was poisoned!

PEACOCK:

AHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH! AHHHHHHHHHHHHHH! AHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH!

GREEN:

Mrs Peacock. Mrs Peacock

AUDIO 12: Slap

GREEN:

I had to stop her from screaming.

ROSIE:

AHHHHHHHH! AHHHHHHH!

(Everyone except Mrs Peacock runs to STAGE LEFT. Mrs Peacock goes OFFSTAGE RIGHT)

PROF PLUM:

[s] WHAT WHAT!

ROSIE:

I ALSO DRANK THE BRANDY!! I DON'T WANT TO DIE!!

SEBASTIAN: Nonono! This is terrible. Not what I intended at all!

WHITE:

Not what you intended? I think you better explain yourself.

SEBASTIAN:

Please sit down everyone. (Everybody gets to sit except Mr. Green) It all began when my wife decided to end her life. You see, Mr. Boddy had been blackmailing her too. He believed you all were not true Indians. He felt that it was inappropriate for a Minister to have a corrupt wife, for a Professor to date his students and so forth.

PEACOCK:

Well, if he was so patriotic then why didn't he report us to the authorities?

SEBASTIAN:

He decided to put his information to good use and make a little money out of it. What could be more Indian than that? The best way to get him behind bars and to free all of you was to get everyone face to face, confront Mr. Boddy and turn him over to the police.

GREEN:

So everything's explained,

PROF PLUM:

Nothing's explained! We still don't know who killed him!

SEBASTIAN:

We got to find out in the next 45 minutes before the police arrive.

SCARLET:

Well who else could it have been? Who else is in this house?

SEBASTIAN:

Only the cook.

ALL:

THE COOK!!

(Everyone rushes to the kitchen)

GREEN:

Well, the cook's not here.

(Cooks dead body falls from STAGE LEFT onto Mr. Green)

GREEN:

[e] I DIDN'T DO IT! *[s]* Somebody help me please, somebody help.

WHITE:

Who would want to kill the cook?

SCARLET:

Dinner wasn't that bad.

COL MUSTARD:

How can you be making jokes at a time like this? If I was the killer, I would kill you next!
(Everyone stares at him)

COL MUSTARD:

Your brains are in your backside or what? I said 'If'. Who had the dagger anyway? Mrs. Peacock, wasn't it?

PEACOCK:

Yes, but I put it down.

PROF PLUM:

Where?

PEACOCK:

In the study

PLUM:

Where?

PEACOCK:

[e] I DON'T KNOW! Before I fainted, after I fai*[p]* - I DON'T KNOW!

SEBASTIAN:

I suggest we take the Cook's body into the study. I'm the butler, I like to keep the kitchen tidy.

(Everyone enters the Study and stops)

PROF PLUM:

[e] LOOK! The body's gone

WHITE:

What are you all staring at?

SEBASTIAN:

Nothing.

WHITE:

Well, who's there?

PROF PLUM:

Nobody.

PEACOCK:

What do you mean nobody?

SEBASTIAN:

No body. That's what we mean. Mr. Boddy's body, it's gone.

PEACOCK:

Oh, I can't handle this. I need to use the ladies room, excuse me. (Goes in hall)

GREEN:

Maybe he wasn't dead.

PEACOCK:

AHHHHHHHHH! AHHHHHHH! SOMEBODY GET HIM OFF!

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey Look! Mr. Boddy's attacking her.

GREEN:

He's dead. Again!

WHITE:

She's going to faint!

SEBASTIAN:

I got her. Fall into my arms. Sorry.

COL MUSTARD:

He's got new injuries. Why would anyone want to kill him twice?

SCARLET:

Seems so unnecessary.

PROF PLUM:

That's what we call overkill.

WHITE:

Unless he wasn't dead before.

GREEN:

What's the difference!

SEBASTIAN:

That's what we're trying to find out! We're trying to find out who killed him and where and with what.

(Everyone goes back to Study)

COL MUSTARD:

Who had access to the candlestick?

SCARLET:

Me. But then everyone did. I dropped it on the table. Anyone could have picked it up.

AUDIO 13: Doorbell

SEBASTIAN:

Can we help you?

INSPECTOR:

Is everything all right? We've received reports of shouting from this property.

MOTORIST:

And my car broke down outside.

INSPECTOR:

So I thought I'd investigate one problem while assisting the other.

MOTORIST:

Do ya'll have a phone we could use?

SEBASTIAN:

Just one moment.

(Everyone huddles up and whispers to discuss.)

SEBASTIAN:

Very well, would ya'll care to come in?

INSPECTOR:

Well, where is it?

GREEN:

What? The body?

INSPECTOR:

The phone. What body?

PROF PLUM:

There's no body. Uh[p] nobody. There's nobody in the study.

SEBASTIAN:

Inspector, you may make your call in the library. Sir, there's a phone you could use in the lounge.

COL MUSTARD:

Sebastian baba, am I right in thinking there is nobody else in this house?

SEBASTIAN:

No

COL MUSTARD:

Then there is someone else in this house.

SEBASTIAN:

No, sorry. I said no meaning yes.

COL MUSTARD:

No meaning yes? Look I want a straight answer. Is there someone else or isn't there, yes or no?

SEBASTIAN:

Um, no.

COL MUSTARD:

No, there is or no there isn't?

SEBASTIAN:

Yes

WHITE:

[e] PLEASE! Don't you think we should get them out of the house before they figure out what's happened?

PEACOCK:

ARREY, WHO CARES? THEY DON'T MATTER. LET THEM STAY LOCKED UP FOR ANOTHER HALF AN HOUR. THE POLICE WILL BE HERE BY THEN AND THERE ARE TWO DEAD BODIES IN THE STUDY!!

(Everyone Shushes her)

COL MUSTARD:

Well, there is still some confusion as to whether or not there's anybody else in this house

SEBASTIAN:

I told you there isn't

COL MUSTARD:

There isn't any confusion or there isn't anybody else?

SEBASTIAN:

Either. Or both

COL MUSTARD:

Just give me a clear answer!

SEBASTIAN:

Certainly. What was the question?

COL MUSTARD:

Is there anybody else in the house?!

ALL:

NO!!

COL MUSTARD:

I suggest we handle this in proper military fashion. We split up into pairs and search the house.

PROF PLUM:

Waaait a minute. Suppose that one of us is the murderer. If we split up into pairs, whichever one is left with the killer might get killed!

COL MUSTARD:

Then we would have discovered who the murderer is, use your head men.

PEACOCK:

But the other half of the pair would be dead!

COL MUSTARD:

This is WAR Peacock. Casualties are inevitable. You cannot make an omelette without breaking eggs. Every cook will tell you that.

PEACOCK:

But look what happened to the Cook!

SEBASTIAN:

Professor Plum and Mrs. Peacock, ya'll search the cellar. Colonel Mustard and Miss Scarlet, the ballroom. Rosie and Mr. Green, the attic is that way. Mrs. White, you're with me.

(complete blackout)

SCENE 4- AROUND THE HOUSE

*(Walls facing the audience as 2 rooms. STAGE RIGHT-CELLAR & STAGE LEFT)
(Prof Plum and Mrs. Peacock enter the cellar from STAGE RIGHT)*

PROF PLUM:

Well, Ladies first.

PEACOCK:

[s] No no no no, *[p]* you can go first.

PROF PLUM:

[s] No no no, I insist. What are you afraid of anyway? A fate worse than death?

PEACOCK:

No, just death. Isn't that enough.

(Sebastian and Mrs. White enter from STAGE LEFT)

SEBASTIAN:

Go on, I'll be right behind you.

WHITE:

That's why I'm nervous. I wish I knew what was behind that door.

SEBASTIAN:

Be careful what you wish for

WHITE:

Why?

SEBASTIAN:

Because if it's another corpse, I will make you carry it.

(Each go through one door then immediately come back to check on each other, then go in again)

(complete blackout)

(Both walls go towards STAGE LEFT, perpendicular to audience. Motorist ONSTAGE RIGHT at telephone facing away from wing.)

(lights come on slowly)

MOTORIST:

I'm a little nervous. I'm in this big house and I've been locked in the lounge.

MOTORIST:

(As this dialogue is being said, a black gloved hand with a wrench is seen rising from the wing)

The funny thing is, there's a whole group of people here having some sort of party and one of them is my old boss from—

(The hand hits the Motorist on the head and he falls to the ground STAGE RIGHT corner. Col Mustard and Miss Scarlet enter from STAGE LEFT through one door)

SCARLET:

Nobody here. What if they're behind that door there?

COL MUSTARD:

You look. I'll search the kitchen.

(Scarlet exits through STAGE RIGHT and Col Mustard exits through the 2nd wall)

ROSIE:

There's a secret passage there which leads to one of the rooms. Search there. I'll go through this passage.

GREEN:

How do you know there are secret passages?

ROSIE:

Because half the rooms in this house are connected to the other half for no sensible reason.....And also because I have to vacuum them every weekend.

(Rosie exits STAGE LEFT and Mr Green exits STAGE RIGHT)

(complete blackout)

(Inspector ONSTAGE LEFT at telephone facing away from wing.)

INSPECTOR:

Hello? Hello? There's something funny going on around here. I don't know what it is but I have a feeling that I'm in danger.

INSPECTOR:

(As this dialogue is being said, a black gloved hand with a lead pipe is seen rising from the wing)
Do you know that big ugly house on top of—

(The hand hits the Inspector on the head and he falls to the ground ONSTAGE LEFT corner. Is pulled offstage.)

(Rosie enters from STAGE RIGHT and walks carefully to the other side of the stage on a constant lookout)

ROSIE:

[o] HUUUHHH! IT'S YOU!

AUDIO 14: Gunshot

(Shot from OFFSTAGE and falls ONSTAGE LEFT back corner. Everyone comes running ONSTAGE from both sides.)

GREEN:

I heard a gunshot!

ALL:

So did I.

WHITE:

AHHHHHHH! Rosie's been shot!

PROF PLUM:

Look! The Inspector! Killed with the lead pipe!

GREEN:

And the Motorist with the wrench!

SCARLET:

Three murders?

GREEN:

5 murders all together.

PLUM:

This is getting serious.

SCARLET:

Oh really? What gave it away, the screaming or the corpses?

WHITE:

Oh just imagine how many funeral masses we'll have to attend.

SEBASTIAN:

Very well. I know who did it.

ALL:

YOU DO?

SEBASTIAN:

And furthermore, I'm going to tell you how it was all done. Follow me.

SEBASTIAN:

In order to help you understand what happened, I shall need to take you through the events of the evening step by step. At the start of the evening, Rosie was here, waiting to offer you all a glass of champagne.

SEBASTIAN:

I was in the hall, I know because I was there. AND THEN the doorbell rang and it was you.

COL MUSTARD:

Yes?

SEBASTIAN:

And then I took you to the library where Rosie met you and smiled. And then the doorbell rang and it was Miss Scarlet, all glamorous and beautiful. Then there was a rumble of thunder and a crash of lightning. KRRRRHHHHH. And to make a long story short.

ALL:

Too late.

SEBASTIAN:

One by one, you all arrived. And then we all made it to the dining room. And Mrs. Peacock sat here, and Professor Plum sat here, and Mrs. White sat here, and Mr Green, Miss Scarlet, Colonel Mustard. This chair was vacant. Anyway, we all revealed we'd all received a letter and you'd had a letter and you'd had a letter and you'd had a letter.

ALL:

YES GO ON!!

SEBASTIAN:

The point is blackmail.

WHITE:

All this came out after dinner in the study.

(All run to the study.)

SEBASTIAN:

Mr Green stood here, and Mrs Peacock here, and Miss Scarlet here, and Professor Plum here, and Colonel Mustard, and Mrs White.

ALL:

GET ON WITH IT!!!

SEBASTIAN:

I'm getting there, I'm getting there. And Mr Boddy went to get his briefcase, and handed you all the weapons and switched off the lights.

(complete blackout)

ALL:

AHHHHHHHHHHHHH!!!

(Lights come back on. Sebastian lying face first on the floor. And then suddenly gets up.)

SEBASTIAN:

Then Mr Boddy lay on the floor, apparently dead.

PROF PLUM:

He was dead! I examined him!

SCARLET:

Then why was he bashed on the head a few minutes later with the candlestick if he was dead already!?

PROF PLUM:

All right I made a mistake!

SEBASTIAN:

But why was he pretending to be dead? It could only be because he realized that his scheme had misfired and the gunshot was intended to kill him, not me. Look, the bullet grazed his ear. But remember what happened next. Mrs Peacock took a drink. You said Maybe it's poisoned. She screams. AHHHH. AHHHH

PEACOCK:

AHHHHH

SEBASTIAN:

AHHH

PEACOCK:

AHHHHH

SEBASTIAN:

AHHH

PEACOCK:

AHHHHH

SEBASTIAN:

Mr Green.

AUDIO 15: Slap

SEBASTIAN:

I had to stop her from screaming. THEN more screaming. Rosie- the other room. We all rushed out. But one of us wasn't here. No

ALL:

No?

SEBASTIAN:

No. Maybe one of us was murdering the cook. Who wasn't here with us?

GREEN:

Do you know?

SEBASTIAN:

I do. While we stood here trying to stop Rosie from panicking, one of us could have stayed in the study, picked up the dagger, RUUNNNN down the hall and stabbed the cook.

PEACOCK:

How could he risk it? We might have seen him running back.

SEBASTIAN:

Not if they used this secret passage.

ALL:

Huhhhhh

SEBASTIAN:

And the murderer ran back down the secret passage to the study, where the secret passage comes out.

SCARLET:

How did you know?

SEBASTIAN:

What do you mean? I work here, I've known all along.

GREEN:

So you could be the murderer?

SEBASTIAN:

Don't be ridiculous. If I was the murderer, why would I reveal to you how I did it?

WHITE:

But what I don't understand is why was the Cook murdered? She had nothing to do with Mr Boddy.

SEBASTIAN:

Of course she did. I gathered you all here together because you were all implicated in Mr. Boddy's dastardly blackmail. Did none of you deduce that the others were involved too?

PROF PLUM:

What? How?

SCARLET:

How were they involved?

SEBASTIAN:

That's how he got all his information! Before he could blackmail anyone, Mr Boddy had to discover their guilty secret. The Cook and Rosie were his accomplices.

COL MUSTARD:

I see! So whoever knew that the cook was involved, killed her?

SEBASTIAN:

Precisely. I know, because I was Mr Boddy's butler, that the cook had worked for one of you.

WHITE:

But where and when was Mr Boddy killed?

SEBASTIAN:

Don't you see. When we came back to the study with Rosie, Mr Boddy was on the floor pretending to be dead, but one of us knew he was alive. So, I explained that I was Mr. Boddy's Butler and I'd invited you here and we realized there was only one other person in the house.

ALL:

THE COOK!

(The others run slowly across the stage. Sebastian runs around BACKSTAGE to fall out from STAGE LEFT)

GREEN:

Well where is he?

SCARLET:

AHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHHH

SEBASTIAN:

By now she was dead. We laid her down with our backs to the freezer. One of us slipped through the same secret passage

PEACOCK:

Againn??

SEBASTIAN:

Of course. Back to the study. The murderer was in the secret passage, meanwhile Mr Boddy on the floor. He jumped up. The murderer came out of the secret passage, picked up the candlestick. Mr Boddy ran into the hall looking for an escape. The murderer crept up behind him AND killed him.

GREEN:

WILL YOU STOP THAT!

SEBASTIAN:

No. Then, he threw him into the toilet and quietly rejoined us beside the cook's body in the kitchen. It took less than half a minute.

PROF PLUM:

So who wasn't there the entire time in the kitchen?

SEBASTIAN:

Whoever he was is the murderer.

AUDIO 16: Toilet flushing

(Sebastian runs, Mr Green comes out of wing wiping his hands on towel)

SEBASTIAN:

Let's look at the other murders.

PEACOCK:

Yes men, bad luck that the Motorist and Inspector arrived at that moment.

SEBASTIAN:

It wasn't luck, I invited them.

ALL:

You did??

SEBASTIAN:

Of course, it's obvious. Everyone here tonight was either Mr. Boddy's victim or accomplice. Everyone who has died gave him vital information about one of you. I got them here so they give evidence against him and force him to confess.

SCARLET:

Oh yeah? What about that motorist? What kind of information did he have?

COL MUSTARD:

He was my driver during the war. He knew that I used to drink on duty and I used military vehicles to smuggle booze.

WHITE:

Was the policeman working for Mr Boddy too?

SCARLET:

The cop was from Bandra. He was on my payroll. I bribed him once a week so I could carry on with business. Mr Boddy found out somehow.

SEBASTIAN:

Let's put the others in the study.

(Everyone takes the bodies OFFSTAGE)

SEBASTIAN:

So, now you all know why they died. Altogether there were five murders. Let's consider each murder one by one. Professor Plum, you knew that Mr Boddy was still alive. Even Bio Professors can tell the difference between life and death. You fired the gun at him in the dark and missed. So you pretended he was dead. That's how you were able to kill him later unobserved.

WHITE:

That's right! He was the missing person in the kitchen after we found the cook dead!

GREEN:

But he was with us when we found Rosie screaming. If that's when the Cook was killed, how did he do it?

PROF PLUM:

I DIDN'T

PEACOCK:

Arrey beta, you don't expect us to believe that do you?

SEBASTIAN:

I expect you to believe it. You killed the cook. She used to be your cook and she informed on you to Mr Boddy. Then later, Colonel Mustard suggested we split up. You separated from Miss Scarlet, crossed the hall to the study, took the wrench, ran to the lounge and killed the motorist with a blow to the head. Like that.

SEBASTIAN:

While they were separated, Miss Scarlet took the opportunity and ran to the library, where she hit the cop whom she'd been bribing on the head with a lead pipe. True or False?

SCARLET:

True! Who are you? Sherlock Holmes?

SEBASTIAN:

And well, we all know Mrs White killed her husband.

COL MUSTARD:

So it must have been Mr Green who killed Rosie!

GREEN:

I didn't do it!

COL MUSTARD:

Well, there's nobody else left.

GREEN:

But I didn't do it! The gun is missing. Whoever's got the gun shot the girl.

(Sebastian pulls gun out of coat)

SEBASTIAN:

I shot her

ALL:

You!?

GREEN:

So it was you. I was going to expose you

SEBASTIAN:

I know. So I chose to expose myself

COL MUSTARD:

Arrey, bugger. There are ladies present.

SEBASTIAN:

You thought Mr Boddy was dead. But why? None of you even met him till tonight.

PEACOCK:

You're Mr Boddy!!

PROF PLUM:

Wait a minute! So who did I kill?

SEBASTIAN:

My butler.

PROF PLUM:

Oh shucks.

SEBASTIAN:

He was expendable like all of you. I'm grateful to you all for disposing of my network of spies and informers. Saved me a lot of trouble. Now there's no evidence against me.

GREEN:

But the police will be here any minute, you won't get away with this, any of you.

SEBASTIAN:

Why should the police come? Nobody's called them.

PEACOCK:

You mean? *[p]* OH MY GOD OF COURSE!

SEBASTIAN:

So why won't we get away with it? We'll stack the body's in the cellar, lock it, leave quietly one at a time and forget any of this ever happened.

GREEN:

And you'll just go on blackmailing us all?

SEBASTIAN:

Of course. Why not?

GREEN:

Well, I'll tell you why not.

AUDIO 17: Gunshot

(Everyone screams)

SEBASTIAN:

Ha, good shot Green.....*[p]* Very good.

WHITE:

Are you a cop?

GREEN:

CBI. I told you I didn't do it.

AUDIO 18: Heroic Police/American Music

(Mr Green opens the door, police come flooding in all pointing guns at the 6)

CBI CHIEF:

All right, whodunnit?

(The 6 start accusing each other saying “He/she did it”. Police keep pointing guns from one person to another.)

GREEN:

They all did it! But if you want to know who killed Mr. Boddy. I did, in the hall, with the revolver. Okay, Chief, take them away. I’m going home to be with my fiance Natasha.